

Outlook

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Follow-up: new column, renamed field or changed meaning?

Team,

Before this becomes another standing report, can we answer the real question?

Data Engineering sees changing schemas and needs to distinguish safe expansion from business-definition drift. The possible stories are that new fields are additive, that null patterns reveal a source rollout rather than missing customer data, or that renamed or recoded fields break history.

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use April 2024 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. The operating teams agree that more journeys are failing; they disagree on whether the customer, the bank or a downstream party owns the failure.

Please prepare a short decision pack with no more than five slides and an attached evidence table. The output must help us decide the data contract, quarantine rule and backfill requirement.

Data available: monthly account snapshots, status events, limits, product enrolments and signatories; monthly customer and KYC snapshots; transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; the latest closed loan files available by the request date, including affordability, pricing and origination risk fields.

Please state the limitation plainly: A technical schema match does not prove semantic consistency; business owners must confirm meaning.

Thanks